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Oscars Preview: Will 'Oppenheimer' sweeps the awards ceremony?

An overview of the Oscars. Photo courtesy of Netflix. Photo courtesy of Warner Bros. Photo courtesy of Universal. Photo courtesy of Neon.

Ethan Le

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As the Oscars nominations rolled out on January 23, Christopher Nolan's 'Oppenheimer' leads the awards with 13 nominations, including Best Picture. Following shortly behind is Yorgos Lanthimos' 'Poor Things' with 11 nominations, including a nomination for its lead, Emma Stone while Martin Scorsese's 'Killers of the Flower Moon' earns 10 nominations. The biggest and pinkest movie of the summer, Greta Gerwig's 'Barbie,' scores eight nominations for itself.

However, as the ceremony approaches closer, the clear front runner to win is clearly critics' favorite: Nolan's 'Oppenheimer'—even Nolan himself is predicted to win Best Director given the overwhelming accolades about the film's directions and technical achievements. Another critics' darling this awards season is Lily Gladstone for 'Killers of the Flower Moon'—her win could make history with the Academy, being the first Native American woman to win in her category.

Within the nominations, there are talks about specific snubs that are left out of the conversation. With 'Barbie' earning eight nominations, there are no recognition for Gerwig or for the film lead, Margot Robbie.

'Past Lives' earns itself two nominations, but unable to grab a Best Director nomination for Celine Song or a Best Leading Actress nomination for Greta Lee. The same argument can be made for Todd Haynes' 'May December' with the biggest upset being Charles Milton missing out on Best Supporting Actor. Still, young actors still cannot break through with the Academy; this includes

Dominic Sessa for 'The Holdovers.' Plus, there are no love for Andrew Heigh's 'All of Us Stranger' where the films got shut out completely—not even an Adapted Screenplay nomination for Heigh.

Along with snubs, there are an abundant of surprises that warm the public's mind. Surprises like 'Godzilla Minus One' earns a nomination for Best Visual Effect—the first ever 'Godzilla' movie to receive an Oscar nomination.

'Anatomy of a Fall' earns itself a Best Director nod for Justine Triet. Plus, for the first time ever in the 96 years of the Oscars, three films out of the 10 is female-directed films, showing a big celebration for female filmmakers. Plus, Colman Domingo surprises the nomination morning with a Best Actor nom for 'Rustin.'

Ultimately, the nominations are mostly aligned with what the public predicted with some outliers cause a disruption to the competition.

The 96th Academy Awards will air on Sunday, March 10 on ABC at 7 p.m. ET/ 4 p.m. PT. [Check out the full list of nominations.](#)

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